

Work Sheet – Formulate the Problem

Batch 21 – Semester 6

Index No: 215111T

Part A – Spotting Research Problems

1. List **three issues** you notice in daily life, news, or academic readings that could be researched:

- o Issue 1: Students often skipping breakfast before lectures
- o Issue 2: Many people preferring online shopping instead of physical stores
- o Issue 3: University students facing difficulties in managing their monthly expenses

2. From the list, choose **one issue** you think is most interesting or important.

- o Chosen issue: University students facing difficulties in managing their monthly expenses.

Part B – Screening the Problem

Check if your chosen problem meets the criteria (✓ or X):

Criteria	Yes /No	Notes
Researchable – Can I collect data about it?	✓	Data can be collected via student surveys and spending records.
Significant – Will it add new knowledge or solve an issue?	✓	Can help students improve financial planning and reduce stress.
Feasible – Do I have time/resources to study it?	✓	Easy to study within time and resource limits.
Ethical – Does it avoid harming anyone?	✓	Data collection is anonymous and voluntary.
Clear & Specific – Is it not too broad or vague?	✓	Focused on student financial management at the university level.

Part C – Formulating the Problem Statement

Use the formula:

“There is a problem because

_____.”

This matters because

_____.”

It is not yet fully understood because

_____.”

- Draft your problem statement here:

There is a problem because many university students struggle to manage their limited monthly allowance effectively.

This matters because poor money management can lead to stress and affect both academic performance and well-being.

It is not yet fully understood because there is limited research on how students actually budget and prioritize their spending in our context.”

Part D – Converting to Research Questions

Write **2–3 research questions** based on your problem:

1. What are the main areas where university students spend most of their monthly allowance?
2. What challenges do students face in managing their expenses?
3. What strategies could help students manage their money more effectively?

- (Optional, for quantitative studies):

Write a hypothesis: Students who prepare a monthly budget manage their expenses more effectively than those who do not.

Part E – Reflection

In 2–3 sentences, write what you learned about identifying and formulating research problems:

This activity demonstrates that the formulation of a research problem is the foundation of any systematic investigation. Converting a general issue into a problem statement and

research questions ensures that the study is researchable, significant, feasible, ethical, and specific. A well-defined problem provides direction, reduces ambiguity, and increases the likelihood of producing meaningful and applicable findings.